AIM — Approval Integrity Module

OriginID: OOF-OID-RIS-AIM-2026-06-28-0005
Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™
Foundation Family: OOF® Foundation Standards™
Operational Layer: Runtime Governance Layer
Governed Space: Approval Integrity
Category: Execution & Enforcement
Subcategory: Runtime Governance
Type: Runtime Integrity Standard Module
Parent Standard: Runtime Integrity Standard™ (RIS™)
Version: 1.0
Status: Canonical · Open Module
Origin Date: 28 June 2026
Compatibility: OOF Methodology OS · Runtime Integrity Standard™ (RIS™) · GOA™ · ORA™ · AGA™ · CLIA® · MGIA™ · AIG™ · ASGA™
AI-Readable: Yes
Authority: OOF®
Protection: MIP™ — Methodological Intellectual Property
Canonical Language: English (UCL™)

Canonical Definition

Approval Integrity Module (AIM) defines the governance conditions under which operational approvals remain valid, explicit, authorized, traceable, verifiable, enforceable, and continuously applicable throughout the complete execution lifecycle.

AIM governs approval integrity.

The module establishes the methodological conditions required to ensure that every significant operational action is executed only under governance-valid approval conditions that remain effective at the exact moment of execution.

Approval is not permission recorded in history.

Approval is governance confirmed at execution.

AIM governs that confirmation.

Module Operational Role

AIM defines the approval governance layer of Runtime Integrity Standard™.

Its role is to ensure that operational execution remains continuously aligned with valid governance approvals, authorization rules, operational boundaries, and organizational decision authority.

Module Operational Space

AIM governs:

- approval integrity
- execution approval
- approval authorization
- approval validation
- approval traceability
- approval governance
- approval lifecycle
- approval evidence

The module applies wherever organizations require governance-valid approval before operational execution.

Module Function

The module applies wherever organizations must preserve:

- valid operational approvals
- explicit authorization
- governance-valid execution
- approval traceability
- approval evidence
- reconstructable approval history

Its function is to ensure that every significant operational action remains independently verifiable as properly approved before and during execution.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Approval Object

Identify which operational actions, decisions, processes, or executions require governance approval.

2. Define Approval Integrity Conditions

The organization shall define:

- approval authority
- approval scope
- approval validity
- execution conditions
- governance evidence
- approval traceability

3. Define Approval Degradation Detection Logic

The governance methodology shall identify:

- missing approvals
- expired approvals
- unauthorized approvals
- approval scope violations
- missing governance evidence
- governance-invalid approval conditions

4. Define Operational Response or Governance Logic

Governance response may include:

- approval validation
- execution suspension
- approval renewal
- governance escalation
- operational reassessment
- approval recovery

5. Preserve Traceability & Restrict Invalid Conditions

The organization shall preserve reconstructable traceability of:

- approval origin
- approving authority
- approval history
- execution linkage
- governance interventions
- resulting operational outcomes

Operational integrity shall not be considered valid if materially significant approvals cannot be reconstructed, reviewed, verified, or governed.

Use Case 1 — AI Financial Transaction

Scenario
An AI system initiates a high-value financial transaction requiring governance approval before execution.

Application
AIM ensures that approval remains valid, explicitly authorized, continuously verifiable, and directly linked to the executed action.

Result
The organization strengthens governance confidence, reduces operational risk, and preserves trustworthy execution.

Use Case 2 — Autonomous Industrial Operations

Scenario

An autonomous production system requests authorization to initiate a high-risk maintenance operation.

Application

AIM verifies that execution proceeds only after governance-valid approval has been confirmed and remains applicable throughout execution.

Result

The organization improves operational safety, reinforces governance discipline, and preserves confidence in autonomous decision execution.

Canonical Closing Statement

Approval protects governance only when it remains valid at the moment action becomes reality; history alone can never authorize the present.

Related Documents

→ Runtime Integrity Standard™ (RIS™)

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Canonical Source

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